

St. John's N.S.
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Code of Behaviour

Introduction:

Our School aims to provide a happy, secure, friendly, learning environment, where children, parents, teachers, ancillary staff and Board of Management work in partnership. Each individual pupil is valued, encouraged and respected for their uniqueness and facilitated to reach their full potential in a positive atmosphere. The purpose of this policy is to promote positive behaviour and to allow the school to function in an orderly and harmonious way whilst promoting a high level of respect and cooperation between staff, parents and pupils.

~~Rosstulla School~~

~~'Together Towards Tomorrow'~~



Rationale:

We wish to ensure our policy and practice at St. John's N.S. is in compliance with all legal requirements and good practice as set out in 'Developing a Code of Behaviour: Guidelines for Schools, NEWB, 2008.

Aims of the policy:

- To allow the school to function in an orderly way where children can make progress in all aspects of their development.
- To create an atmosphere of respect, tolerance and consideration for others.
- To promote positive behaviour and self-discipline, recognising the differences between children and the need to accommodate these differences.
- To ensure the safety and well-being of all members of the school community.
- To assist parents and pupils in understanding the systems and procedures that form part of the code of behaviour and to seek their cooperation in the application of these procedures.
- To ensure that the system of rules and sanctions are implemented in a fair and consistent manner throughout the school.

1. Guidelines for behaviour in the school

- The standards of behaviour the school wishes to promote are as follows:
 - Each pupil is expected to be well behaved and to show consideration for other children and adults.
 - Each pupil is expected to show respect for the property of the school, other children's property and their own belongings.
 - Each pupil is expected to attend school on a regular basis and to be punctual.
 - Each pupil is expected to do his/her best at all times.
- We recognise that factors influencing children's behaviour may sometimes need to be considered and accommodated.

2. Whole school approach in promoting positive behaviour

The elements of a whole school approach to behaviour include:

- An ethos, policies and practices that are in harmony
- A teamwork approach to behaviour
- A whole-school approach to curriculum and classroom management
- An inclusive and involved school community
- A systematic process for planning and reviewing behaviour policy

Board of Management

- Has a duty of care for the pupils attending the school
- Must fulfil its obligations for all members of the school community under the Safety, Health and Welfare at Work Act (2005)
- Must ensure the school is a safe environment for pupils, teachers and all other members of the school community
- Must ensure that all members of the school community are involved in the drawing up and implementation of the Code
- Was actively involved in reviewing this Code of Behaviour.
- Supports the Code of Behaviour in the school by endorsing every aspect of it and complying with the various procedures involved in suspension or expulsion.
- Supports the staff in implementing the Code of Behaviour by facilitating funding for any training that may be deemed necessary.

Safety policies

Parents/Guardians

- Have the right to have a safe and welcoming environment for their child and to be treated with respect
- Co-operation between staff and parents is encouraged by meeting with parents of new Junior Infants at an information evening at the beginning of the school year. Formal parent/teacher meetings are also held annually. Parents are informed that they may arrange a meeting by appointment with the class teacher if they have any concerns regarding their child.
- Were actively involved in reviewing this Code of Behaviour.
- The Code of Behaviour is published on the school website. Parents are required to confirm in writing that the Code of Behaviour is acceptable to them and that they shall make all reasonable efforts to ensure compliance with such code by the child.
- Parents with an issue regarding another child's behaviour during school time should bring the matter to the teacher's attention. It is not recommended that they deal with the matter themselves.
- Parents support the school in the promotion of positive behaviour and the maintenance of high standards of behaviour in the following ways:
 - Parents are aware of and co-operate with the school's system of rules and sanctions.
 - Parents ensure their children attend regularly and punctually.
 - Parents attend meetings at the school if requested.
 - Parents help their children with homework and ensure that it is completed.
 - Parents ensure their children have the necessary books and materials for school.
 - Parents ensure their children wear the correct uniform.
 - Parents communicate constructively with school staff and Board of Management in matters affecting their child.
 - Parents should ensure that their child has an acceptable level of hygiene as a courtesy to other pupils.
 - Parents should make the school aware of any relevant changes/stress in the home environment which may affect the child's behaviour.

❖ Staff

- Teachers have the right to be treated with respect; teach in a safe, appropriate physical environment and to have support and cooperation from pupils, parents, colleagues and Board of Management.
- Teachers are expected to support and implement the school's Code of Behaviour; create an inclusive and positive learning environment for each pupil and promote cooperation with parents/guardians for the benefit of each pupil's education.
- The Code of Behaviour is available on the website to new and temporary staff.
- The Code of Behaviour caters for children who may present behavioural difficulties arising from their special education needs. This is done by ensuring that standards and rules are communicated by teachers in a way that students with special educational needs can understand. There will be a particular need for these pupils to be reminded of the rules and to check their understanding of the rules.
- The school's SPHE curriculum is used to support the Code of Behaviour. It aims to help the pupils develop communication skills, appropriate ways of interacting and behaving, and conflict resolution skills. It also aims to foster self-esteem and to help children accommodate differences and develop citizenship. The SPHE curriculum is delivered as stated in the SPHE policy.

❖ Pupils

- Pupils have the right to be treated fairly, consistently and with respect
- Pupils are expected to cooperate with all staff within the school community; to accept the authority and rules of the school and to respect all members of the school community, including peers, staff and school property.
- Pupils were involved in reviewing the Code of Behaviour by working with the class teachers to draw up classroom and playground rules.
- Pupils are given the opportunity to monitor and review the code of behaviour during SPHE classes when discussions are held on behaviour and pupils are reminded of the rules.

Behaviour in class

Courtesy and respect are essential. Disrespectful behaviour towards other pupils or towards a teacher (e.g. defiance, cheek, insolence) are unacceptable. Pupils must respect the right of other pupils to learn. Any behaviour which interferes with the right (e.g. constant disruption of the class, persistent distracting of others) is considered unacceptable behaviour. In order that pupils benefit from their work in class full cooperation is required at all times. Pupils must cooperate with instructions given by the teacher.

The Essential Classroom Rules

1. Be ready for class
2. Good manners are expected at all times
3. Always do your best and allow others to do the same

Raise hand, wait for attention and listen to the person who is speaking

First Aid

Administration of medication

Fire Safety

4. Emergency Evacuation

5. Take good care of personal and classroom property
6. Ensure you are safe in class and make it safe for others

Behaviour in the Playground

Pupils should treat others as they would like to be treated themselves. Any behaviour which endangers or offends others is not permitted. Rough behaviour e.g. fighting, kicking, spitting, pushing is forbidden. Games or activities considered to be dangerous shall be prohibited.

Any behaviour which interferes with other pupils' play is not permitted. Pupils may not leave the playground for any reason during breaks without permission of the supervising teacher. This includes re-entering the school building.

The Essential Playground Rules

1. Stay within the boundaries in yard

2. Play safely and fairly. Treat others fairly, the way you would like yourself to be treated
3. Keep yard and school environment litter free and tidy
4. Stay clear of fire alarm and respect all school property
5. Leave and return to the classroom in an orderly fashion.

3. Positive strategies for managing behaviour

The following are the positive strategies used throughout the school to promote good behaviour and to prevent misbehaviour:

● Classroom:

- Pupils have had an input in devising the classroom rules. (see Appendix 1.)
- Teachers ensure that pupils understand, and are frequently reminded of, how they are expected to behave.
- A clear system of sanctions for misbehaviour is adhered to.
- Classroom management techniques ensure that a variety of activities and methodologies to sustain pupil interest and motivation are in place.
- Timetabling is arranged in keeping with Department guidelines.

● Playground:

- Pupils have had an input in devising the playground rules. (see Appendix 1.)
- Pupils are not allowed to go out to the yard without permission.
- The playground is always supervised at break times. This supervision is carried out by the class teacher. If a SNA has been appointed to a particular child he/she could assist the supervisor in the playground.
- When pupils are going to and returning from the playground they are supervised by the teacher on duty.
- The teacher on duty will also administer first aid to children who suffer injury during playtime.
- On wet days, or other days when the use of the playground is deemed unsuitable, pupils remain indoors in their own classroom, under the supervision of their class teacher. They are allowed to play suitable games i.e. board games, jigsaws etc.
- Incidents of serious/gross misbehaviour are recorded in an incident book. The incident is reported to the classroom teacher and parents will be notified.

Other areas in the school:

Children are regularly reminded that they must be quiet when going to and from the toilets and when using the hand basins in the back corridor of the school. This is an area common to both classrooms and any noise can cause disturbance to both classrooms. Children are not allowed access to the office, kitchen or bathroom unless they have been given permission by their teacher.

Restorative Practice

Restorative Practice in our school provides a focus on developing positive relationships between all members of the school community. It gives opportunities for pupils to take responsibility for their behaviour and learning. Restorative Practice is a process whereby children are given the opportunity to reflect on their behaviour and how they and others have been affected by it so as to help heal broken relationships and prevent reoccurrence. Where suspension occurs, the school will use restorative practice involving all parties affected to help repair the harm done.

Restorative Questions to respond to Challenging Behaviour

1. What happened?

2. What were you thinking about at the time?
3. What have your thoughts been since?
4. Who has been affected by what you did?
5. In what way have they been affected?
6. What do you think needs to happen to make things right?

To help those harmed by other actions

1. What did you think when you realised what had happened?
2. What have your thoughts been since?
3. How has this affected others?
4. What has been the hardest thing for you?
5. What do you think needs to happen to make things right?

4. Rewards and Sanctions

Rewards and acknowledgement of good behaviour

- Individual pupil or classroom-based achievement (winning a competition etc.) is acknowledged during assembly.
- Teachers operate their own reward systems as appropriate or as/when deemed necessary
Different reward systems work better with different age groups and may need to be adapted
to suit the needs of particular classes and even individuals within that class group.

❖ Strategies for dealing with unacceptable behaviour

- The following behaviours are seen as unacceptable: being cheeky, telling lies, teasing, bullying, using bad language, using rude gestures, abusing property, noisy and disruptive behaviour, deliberate disobedience, deliberate time wasting, kicking, fighting, spitting, injuring others, being unkind to others, throwing objects, stealing, threatening others.
- For the purpose of example, minor misbehaviour might include being cheeky or teasing. Serious misbehaviour might be fighting or abusing property. Gross misbehaviour could include injuring others or stealing. The degree of misdemeanours i.e. minor, serious or gross, will be judged by the teachers and/or Principal based on a common sense approach with regard to the gravity/frequency of such misdemeanours.
- Positive encouragement and reinforcement are regarded as primary in helping pupils to develop responsibility, a positive attitude and self-discipline. However, where a pupil wilfully disregards school rules and infringes on the rights of others, sanctions may be needed. The following are the sanctions we have put in place and are listed in order of severity depending on the nature of the misbehaviour and whether it is a repeated behaviour.
 - (a) Reasoning with the pupil
 - (b) Reprimand (including advice on how to improve)
 - (c) Temporary separation from peers, friends or others
 - (d) Loss of privileges
 - (e) Detention during break
 - (f) Prescribing additional work
 - (g) Referral to Principal Teacher / letter of apology required
 - (h) Communication with parents
 - (i) Suspension
 - (j) Expulsion

- Minor misbehaviour will be dealt with under (a) to (f), serious misbehaviour would involve (g) to (h), gross misbehaviour will be dealt with under (g) to (j).
- In the case of (a) to (f) the class teacher would apply the sanctions. If these sanctions were seen to fail to resolve the problem or the misbehaviour was of a serious/ gross manner then the principal would need to be involved and possibly the parents also. In the case of the need to implement (i) or (j) then the BOM would also be involved in dealing with the issue.
- Consistency in the application of sanctions is ensured by good communication between the members of staff and the keeping of records of serious misbehaviour.

❖ Involving parents in management of problem behaviour

- Parents are contacted if sanctions to deal with minor misbehaviour are seen to fail.
- Parents will be contacted immediately in the case of serious/ gross misbehaviour.
- Parents will be contacted by the principal in writing or by phone and parents may be requested to attend a meeting in the school.
- Those present at the meeting with the parents would usually be the principal and teacher/teachers involved.
- In some cases the child will be present for part of or all of the meeting.
- Parents are encouraged to contact the school if they have concerns. They are requested to make an appointment for a time mutually suitable to both parties.
- When a child engages in repeated acts of minor misbehaviour a regular reporting system may be operated between the parent and the classroom teacher.

❖ Managing aggressive or violent misbehaviour

- Children who are emotionally disturbed are referred for psychological assessment.
- Appropriate support is sought from services available e.g. Health Service Executive/ NEPS etc

❖ Applying sanctions in response to behaviour that takes place outside of school

- The standards and rules contained in this Code of Behaviour also apply in any situation where the student, although outside the school, is still the responsibility of the school. Such occasions would include school tours, games, and attendance at any events organised by the school where the teaching staff are present.
- The school does not assume any responsibility for behaviour which takes place on the bus which transports children to and from the school.

5. Suspension / Expulsion:

❖ Suspension

Suspension is defined as requiring the pupil to absent himself/ herself from the school for a specified, limited period of school days.

Suspension should be a proportionate response to the behaviour that is causing concern. Normally, other interventions will have been tried before suspension, and school staff will have reviewed the reasons why these have not worked. The decision to suspend a pupil requires serious grounds such that:

- The pupil's misbehaviour has had a seriously detrimental effect on the education of other pupils
- The pupil's continued presence in the school at this time constitutes a threat to safety.
- The student is responsible for serious damage to property.

A single incident of serious misconduct may be grounds for suspension.

● Procedures in respect of suspension:

- Ensure all other means of dealing with the behaviour have been tried.
 - Previous communication will have been made with parents regarding misbehaviour.
 - A fair investigation will have taken place, taking parents' and pupil's perspective into account. (page 67 NEWB Guidelines for Developing School Codes of Behaviour)
 - If the BOM is likely to reach a decision to exclude a pupil, it will ensure the decision will be reached in an unbiased manner. NEWB Guidelines for Developing School Codes of Behaviour P67/68
 - Parents will be informed in writing as to the nature of the complaint, how it will be investigated and that it could result in suspension. The school will keep a record of any such correspondence.
 - Parents are invited to the school to discuss the intention to exclude.
- Parents and pupils will be given an opportunity to respond before a decision is made and before any sanction is imposed.

Agreed by Governing Body, October 2024

Chairperson's Signature _____ **Date:** _____

Objective

~~The objective of this policy is to ensure, so far as is "reasonably practicable", that no person is placed in a situation where injury or ill health may be caused as a result of the school and that all such risks are assessed and appropriately controlled.~~

- _____
- Immediate suspension is warranted where the safety of the pupil, other pupils, staff or others is at risk.
- A student should not be suspended for more than three days, except in exceptional circumstances where the Principal considers that a period of suspension longer than three days is in order.
- If a suspension longer than three days is being proposed by the principal, the matter should be referred to the Board of Management for consideration and approval.
- Following such consideration a ceiling of ten days is, normally, placed on any one period of suspension.
- The Board will formally review any proposal to suspend a pupil, where the suspension would bring the number of days for which the pupil has been suspended in the current school year to twenty days or more. Any such suspension is subject to appeal under section 29 of the Education Act 1998.
- Where a student has been suspended for a cumulative total of six or more days, 'TUSLA: Educational Welfare Services – Child and Family Agency' is notified using the standard form. (Forms are available on the TUSLA website)

❖ Implementing the Suspension:

The principal will notify the parents and the pupil in writing of the decision to suspend. The letter will confirm:

- The period of suspension and the dates on which the suspension will begin and end
- The reasons for the suspension.
- Any study programme to be followed.
- The arrangements for returning to school, including parents being asked to reaffirm their commitment to the code of behaviour.

- The provision for an appeal to the Board of Management.
- The right to appeal to the Secretary General of the Dept. of Education and Science (Education Act 1998, section 29)
- The letter will be clear and easy to understand with particular care being taken when communicating with parents who have reading difficulties or whose first language is not English.

❖ **Removing a Suspension/ After the suspension ends:**

- A suspension will be removed if the Board of Management decides to do so for any reason or if the Secretary General of the Dept. of Education and Science directs that it should be removed.
- The period of suspension will, otherwise, end on the date given in the letter of notification to the parents about the suspension.
- When the period of suspension is completed the pupil will be given the opportunity and support for a fresh start.

❖ **Records and Reports:**

Formal written records will be kept of

- The investigation (including notes of all interviews held)
- The decision-making process
- The decision and rationale for the decision
- The duration of the suspension and any conditions attached to the suspension.
- The Principal will report all suspensions to the BOM.
- The Principal will report suspensions to 'TUSLA: Educational Welfare Services – Child and Family Agency' in accordance with guidelines.

❖ **Expulsion (permanent exclusion)**

A pupil is expelled from school when the Board of Management makes a decision to permanently exclude him or her from the school, having complied with section 24 of the Education Welfare Act 2000. Expulsion should be a proportionate response to the pupil's behaviour and should only be taken by the Board of Management in extreme cases of unacceptable behaviour. The following steps will be taken to address the misbehaviour and to avoid expulsion of a pupil:

- meeting with parents and the pupil to try to find ways to help the pupil to change his/ her behaviour
- making sure that the pupil understands the possible consequences of his/ her behaviour, if it should persist
- ensuring that all other possible options have been tried
- seeking the assistance of support agencies (e.g. National Psychological Service, Health Service Executive Community Services, The National Behavioural Support Service, Child and Adolescent Mental Health Services, National Council for Special Education).

The grounds for expulsion are similar to the grounds for suspension but will only be implemented when school authorities have tried a series of other interventions and believe that all possibilities for changing the pupil's behaviour have been exhausted.

❖ Expulsion for a first offence:

In exceptional circumstances the Board of Management can form the opinion that a student should be expelled for a first offence. Such behaviours may include:

- actual violence or physical assault against another pupil or member of staff
- supplying illegal drugs to other students in the school
- sexual assault

❖ Procedures in respect of expulsion: The following steps will be strictly adhered to:

- A detailed investigation will be carried out under the direction of the Principal.
- A recommendation will be made to the Board of Management by the Principal.
- The Board of management will consider the Principal's recommendation at a hearing.
- Board of Management will deliberate and take actions following the hearing.
- Consultations will be arranged by the Educational Welfare Officer.
- Confirmation will be made of the decision to expel.

These steps are explained in detail in the NEWB Book 'Developing a Code of Behaviour: Guidelines for Schools' as issued in May 2008 (pages 83- 86)

❖ Appeals

- Under Section 29 of the Education Act, 1998, parents are entitled to appeal to the Secretary General of the Department of Education and Science against some decisions of the Board of Management, including (1) permanent exclusion from a school and (2) suspension for a period which would bring the cumulative period of suspension to 20 school days or longer in any one school year. Accordingly, schools should advise parents of this right of appeal and associated timeframe if it has been decided to suspend or permanently exclude a pupil. Parents will be given a copy of Circular 22/02 and related forms. Appeals must be made within 42 calendar days from the date the decision of the school was notified to the parent or student. (Circular 22/02)
- A response will be prepared by the Board of Management if and when an appeal is being investigated by the Dept of Education and Science (Section 12, Circular 22/02 – Processing of an Appeal)

6. Keeping records

Records are written in a factual and impartial manner.

❖ Class level

- Serious misbehaviour is reported to the principal as and when it occurs. The principal is also informed when repeated minor misbehaviour takes place and fails to be resolved using sanctions carried out by the class teacher.
- The end of year report includes a reference to behaviour. There is a consistent understanding of what constitutes excellent – poor behaviour among the staff. Parents are kept up to date during the year regarding behaviour issues during parent /teacher meetings.

❖ Playground

- Supervising teachers keep a record of serious/gross misbehaviour in the incident book. This information is passed onto other members of staff when it occurs.
- Consistency in the application and interpretation of the rules is maintained through regular consultation amongst staff members.

❖ School records

- o Serious incidents will be recorded in an incident book. This book is stored in the filing cabinet in the office.
- o Formal records which are kept at school level include factual reports of particular incidents, communication between school and home, communication with outside agencies, Board of Management, documentation pertaining to appeals under Section 29 of the Education Act 1998.

7. Procedures for notification of pupil absences from school

- Section 18 of The Education Welfare Act, 2000 stipulates that parents must notify the school of a student's absence and the reason for this absence. Therefore, parents/guardians must send in a note informing teachers in writing of their child's absence from school and the reason for this absence. This Absence Form can now be submitted online via the school website. (Refer to Attendance Policy)
- The school uses the standard forms, on-line, to report on pupil absences to 'TUSLA: Educational Welfare Services – Child and Family Agency'. In accordance with the Education Welfare Act, the National Education Welfare Officer will be notified of absences of twenty days and above. The school will also notify parents when their child has been absent for twenty days.

8. Reference to other Policies

Other school policies that have a bearing on the code of behaviour:

- o SPHE plan
- o Anti-bullying Policy
- o Child Safeguarding and Risk Assessment Statement
- o Admissions Policy
- o Record keeping Policy
- o Health & Safety Policy
- o Equality Policy
- o Special Educational Needs Policy
- o Attendance Policy

These policies are available to parents on request.

Success Criteria:

The following are indicators of the success of the policy:

- Observation of positive behaviour in classrooms, playground and school environment
- Practices and procedures listed in this policy being consistently implemented by teachers
- Positive feedback from teachers, parents and pupils

Rationale

The health and safety of all pupils, staff and **Roles and Responsibilities:**

- The Board of Management has been involved in formulating the policy and has the responsibility to act according to the guidelines regarding suspension and expulsion.
- Members of the teaching staff have responsibility for the implementation of this policy. The Board of management has the responsibility of ensuring that the guidelines pertaining to suspension and expulsion are strictly adhered to.
- The principal will coordinate and monitor the implementation of this policy.
- The principal and teachers, SNAs and any other teaching staff will act according to the policy.

- Pupils were involved in drawing up the original policy in 2017 by helping to form classroom and playground rules. Pupils were asked to review these rules in December 2021. They have a duty to adhere to these rules and co-operate with any sanctions that may need to be put in place.
- Parents were involved in the formulation of the original policy in 2017 and were invited to give feedback on the policy in November 2021 prior to review by the Board of Management. Parents have the responsibility to support the teaching staff and the Board of Management as they implement the policy.

Communication, Implementation, Ratification and Review:

This Code of Behaviour and its review has been considered by parents, teachers, pupils in the school and the Board of Management. The policy will be published on the school website. The code is mindful of the Curriculum, the school's Health & Safety Statement, Anti-Bullying Policy, Admissions Policy and Child Safeguarding and Risk Assessment Statement.

This Code of Behaviour came into effect on the 31st August 2017. The revised Code of Behaviour came into effect on the 13th December 2021. This policy will be reviewed in accordance with our school plan or as and when deemed necessary by the Board of Management.

The Board of Management officially ratified the policy on Tuesday, 4th April, 2017. It was reviewed and ratified on Friday 10th December 2021.

Signed by: _____ Dated: _____
Chairperson

Signed by: _____ Dated: _____
Principal

Appendix 1

visitors to the premises and grounds of Rosstulla School remains our top priority. This policy has been developed and adopted by the governors with reference to the advice and procedures contained in the Health and Safety Policy of the former North Eastern Education and Library Board (August 2004) now Education Authority (EA) North Eastern Region (NER).

Rosstulla recognises and accepts its responsibility for health and safety as an employer, and in particular the duties laid down in:

- Article 4 (Employers Duties) of the Health & Safety at Work (Northern Ireland) Order 1978;
- Articles 5 and 6 of that Order in respect to persons other than its employees; and
- Article 88 of the Education and Libraries (Northern Ireland) Order 1986.

Where reasonably practicable the school will pay particular attention to the provision and maintenance of:

- a safe place of work, safe access to it and safe egress from it;
- plant, equipment and systems of work that are safe;
- safe arrangements for the use, handling, storage and transport of articles and substances;
- sufficient information, instruction, training and supervision to enable all employees to avoid risk and contribute positively to health and safety at work;
- a healthy working environment; and
- adequate welfare facilities.

So far as is reasonably practicable, we will provide and maintain up to date information for all staff on the hazards and risks of substances, equipment and systems used at work including the recommendations of relevant risk assessments. The school will rely on EA to provide competent technical advice on safety and health matters and, where necessary, to assist in effecting improvements.

The school will co-operate fully with queries from staff representatives and recognised trade unions. It is mindful of its responsibility to consult with all members of staff on issues of health and safety. Staff are reminded of their duties under Article 8 of the Health and Safety at Work (Northern Ireland) Order, 1978: to take reasonable care for their own safety and that of others.

The school has a Health and Safety Team to monitor and increase the effectiveness of its Health and Safety Policy. The team meets termly.

The Board of Governors

This school's board of governors recognise their statutory duty to ensure health and safety on premises under their control. They also acknowledge their responsibility to ensure that the Education Authority's (EA) health and safety policy is both understood and implemented in their school, that risk assessments are carried out to address significant risks, and that they operate within the procedures and guidelines set out in the employing authority's scheme of management.

In fulfilling these duties and responsibilities the board of governors will:

- ensure that the school principal and management team develop a safety management system throughout the school;
- monitor the effectiveness of the school's health and safety arrangements;
- develop and implement arrangements to ensure that:
 - all school risk assessments are completed and are implemented;
 - equipment and materials purchased by the school are safe and suitable for their intended use;
 - contractors carry out their work in a safe manner;

- ~~prompt and efficient maintenance is carried out on:~~
 - ~~— all non-structural repairs;~~
 - ~~— all equipment;~~
- ~~ensure that arrangements are developed for the annual inspection of the school premises; and adopt a Plan, Do, Check, Act system in dealing with any issues arising from this inspection.~~
- ~~ensure that both teaching and non-teaching staff are issued with a copy of the employer's health and safety policy.~~

The Principal

The principal has overall responsibility for the health, safety and welfare of all children and staff and for ensuring that members of the general public who may be affected by any activity undertaken by or on behalf of the school are not exposed to reasonably foreseeable risks to their health or safety.

The principal is responsible for the day-to-day application of the Health and Safety Policy. In discharging this responsibility the principal will:

- ~~ensure that all teaching staff hold appropriate qualifications both to teach the subjects required of them and to use the necessary equipment and machinery;~~
- ~~ensure that both teaching and non-teaching staff are provided with training that will help them work safely;~~
- ~~ensure the provision and maintenance of procedures for the safety of all teaching and non-teaching staff;~~
- ~~ensure that all staff are aware of any instructions or safety advice pertaining to their particular discipline issued by EA or DENI;~~
- ~~ensure that all safety reports pertaining to the school are understood and that the detailed work has been completed;~~
- ~~ensure that adequate arrangements exist for carrying out regular fire drills and that all staff are aware of, and participate in, such arrangements;~~
- ~~ensure that safe systems of working are used by contractors or persons carrying out inspections or non-structural repairs that are the governors' responsibility as set out in the Scheme for the Local Management of Schools;~~
- ~~report all defects and hazards to the relevant officers in the EA (NER);~~
- ~~ensure that all accidents to children, teaching staff and non-teaching staff are reported promptly to the EA (NER); and~~
- ~~ensure that all staff operate safe working practices in the execution of their duties.~~
- ~~Health and safety induction is carried out for all new staff (appendix 1)~~

~~In the absence of the principal the vice-principal, acting principal or nominated senior teacher will assume the role.~~

Building Supervisor

The building supervisor's line manager is the Principal

In the discharge of this responsibility the building supervisor will:

- ~~ensure that routine maintenance checks and inspections required by legislation of fixed service equipment, i.e. boilers, pressure vessels etc. are undertaken~~
- ~~ensure that premises safety inspections are undertaken e.g. weekly, bi-termly, and keep records of any faults identified (if appropriate);~~
- ~~attend to defect reports and recommendations from the principal and staff;~~
- ~~ensure that all portable electrical equipment is tested on an annual basis;~~
- ~~ensure all accidents within the area of responsibility are recorded in line with the school policy;~~
- ~~ensure equipment, including personal protection equipment is maintained in a safe condition and that substances hazardous to health are stored in a safe place.~~
- ~~carry out or allocate the undertaking of risk assessments which include manual handling, COSHH, and to ensure details are documented and that appropriate action is carried out;~~
- ~~liaising with contractors and maintenance contractors.~~
- ~~assist the Principal and Governors in actioning the annual Health and Safety plan.~~

Teaching Staff

Each member of the teaching staff has a responsibility to exercise care and attention regarding the safety of themselves and pupils under their control. In the discharge of this responsibility all teachers shall:

- ensure that they take reasonable care during work activities to avoid accident or injury to themselves, other members of staff and pupils;
- observe all safety instructions and advice issued by EA or DENI and all safety rules relating to specific machinery or processes;
- ensure that all necessary protective clothing and equipment is both available and used by themselves and pupils;
- report all potential hazards affecting health and safety to the principal and make recommendations on the provision of safety equipment and on improvements to plant, tools or equipment which are dangerous, or potentially so;
- report all accidents to the principal and ensure that accident or incident report forms are fully completed;
- co-operate fully with the principal on all matters pertaining to health and safety;
- exercise effective supervision of pupils and know emergency procedures in respect of fire, first aid etc;
- know any special safety measures to be adopted in their own teaching area and ensure they are applied;
- give clear instruction and warnings to children as often as is necessary and follow safe working procedures personally.



All Employees

All employees have a responsibility to exercise personal care and attention for the safety of themselves and others and to co-operate with their employer in the execution of this policy. In the discharge of this responsibility all employees shall:

- co-operate with any health and safety training considered necessary and reasonably practicable;
- perform their duties in a safe manner;
- ensure that all toxic and flammable substances are correctly used, stored and labelled;
- ensure that they are aware of any safety precautions to be taken when undertaking potentially hazardous procedures;
- ensure that all necessary protective clothing and equipment are available;
- report all potential hazards and defects in equipment and protective clothing to the principal;
- include safe working methods in instruction to pupils;
- ensure that any equipment or machinery known to need repair is not used until the necessary work has been carried out;
- report all accidents and injuries to the principal as soon as possible;
- obtain adequate treatment as soon as practicable if injured;
- assist in the investigation of injuries and accidents as necessary; and
- observe the safety rules of EA and school.



Procedures for Contractors and external maintenance personnel

- Only EA approved contractors and maintenance personnel are to be allowed on site.
- The Building Supervisor is responsible for the liaising with contractors and maintenance contractors.
- The building supervisor has a responsibility to take appropriate action if he/she observes the contractor or his employees using any working practice or item of equipment which he/she considers to be dangerous or potentially dangerous. Such action could include reporting the matter to the Principal.
- The building supervisor must ensure that a contractor arriving at site reports to Reception and

~~that he/she ensures that the contractors are informed of any hazards on the school site e.g. asbestos.~~

- ~~• Approval must be gained by the contractor to start work. Only those staff nominated by the principal to liaise with the contractors must undertake this activity due to the procedures put in place by the school to implement the EA's policy on Asbestos and the Management of Contractors.~~

~~COVID HEALTH AND SAFETY~~

~~All staff, pupils and visitors to the school should follow COVID related health and safety rules set by DE under guidance from PHA.~~

First Aid Procedures

Mrs Clugston, Mrs McCartney, Miss Davidson, Mrs Currie, Miss Fleming, Mrs Trimble and Mrs Agnew are the **qualified first aiders** who will provide first aid if required during the school day.

Sending a Student for First Aid

Member of staff to accompany student (if required). Primary should go to Miss Fleming, Mrs Agnew, Mrs Trimble or Miss Davidson in the first instance. Secondary should go to Mrs McCartney, Mrs Clugston or Mrs Currie in the first instance.

First Aid kits are stored in the following locations

General Office

Secondary Learning Space (KS3 corridor)

Mrs Clugston's year 10 room (KS3 corridor)

The Tigers room (Primary Corridor)

Modular Building

Primary Kitchen

Technology and Design, Home Economics & Science labs

Gym

Minibus

~~These~~  will be checked at the end of each term by Miss Davidson and Mrs McCartney.

A record will be kept of any first aid treatment given in school. Records are to be completed by the first aider and sent to the main office for storage in the 'First Aid File' with a duplicate in the pupil folder

EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

- ~~1. The identified first aiders will also provide emergency aid if, during the school day, a student/member of staff sustains a serious injury or requires emergency treatment.~~
- ~~2. If necessary, the first aider will send a message to the office (by whatever means possible) where an ambulance will be called.~~
- ~~3. The most senior member of staff present will be informed~~
- ~~4. Parent/next of kin informed as directed by the senior member of staff.~~

Student/member of staff will be accompanied in ambulance by a member of staff medical consent form to accompany the injured party to casualty

In minor cases, for example, minor head injury, parents will be asked to collect the child and either keep under close observation or take to medical centre for further investigation. (Head injury guidance and record forms in office)

If the first aider is in any doubt they should contact the emergency services for advice.

Some members of staff have defibrillator training but any member of staff may use the defibrillator if necessary.



~~Under no circumstances should a member of staff transport an injured pupil/staff member to casualty.~~

First Aid (Off Site)

~~PE staff should take their own first aid kit to sporting events. This is to be checked termly by Miss Davidson and Mrs McCartney and replenished as required~~

~~In the event of an accident offsite the following procedure school be followed:~~

- ~~1. Call the onsite first aider~~
- ~~2. Call the emergency services if necessary~~
- ~~3. Inform the school immediately and advise the most senior member of staff of the situation~~
- ~~4. Senior staff will further support and advise you via phone and /or by coming to the scene~~
- ~~5. School will in turn inform the parents carer of the situation~~

~~All relevant forms should be completed upon return to school~~

~~Please note as there may not always be a first aider present on school outings the lead staff should always carry alcohol wipes, rubber gloves and plasters which all staff are free to administer.~~



Record Keeping

~~In addition to the forms (AR1 and AR2—available from office) that have to be completed when you have treated a student make sure that you keep a record of the events surrounding the incident.~~

Student Care Plans

~~Students with Care Plans should be dealt with by LSAs with additional special needs who have been trained in and signed the care plan.~~

Reporting an accident

~~All accidents / injuries involving pupils or staff must be recorded on the EA online Accident Reporting App. Reports should be saved in draft and submitted to Principal for approval.~~

~~<https://schoolapps.eani.org.uk/acReporting/>~~

Policy for the Administration of Medicine in School



~~The Board of Governors and staff of Rosstulla School wish to ensure that pupils with medication needs receive appropriate care and support at school. The Principal will accept responsibility in principle for members of the school staff giving or supervising pupils taking prescribed medication during the school day where those members of staff have volunteered to do so or are expected to do so as part of their job description.~~

~~The School will make every effort to continue the administration of medication to a pupil whilst on trips away from the school premises even if additional arrangement might be required, however there may be occasions when it will not be possible to include a pupil on a school trip if appropriate supervision cannot be guaranteed.~~

~~All staff will be made aware of the procedures to be followed in the event of an emergency.~~

~~Where it is appropriate to do so, pupils will be encouraged to administer their own medication, if necessary under staff supervision.~~

Parental Responsibility:

~~**Parents/ carers should keep their children at home if acutely unwell or infectious.**~~

- ~~• Provide comprehensive information regarding the pupil's condition and medication.~~
- ~~• Complete the required forms re prescribed medication (AM1 and AM2 forms—available on request form main office). Medication will not be accepted without the completed forms.~~

- Providing written permission for the administration of non-prescribed medication.
- Providing reasonable quantities of medication to the school (for example, a maximum of four weeks supply at any one time).
- Where the pupil travels on school transport ensuring the escort has written instructions relating to any medication sent with the pupil including medication for administration.

Deliver each item of medication to the Vice Principal **in a secure and labelled container as originally dispensed.** Each item of medication must be clearly labelled with the following information:

- Pupil's Name
- Name of medication
- Dosage
- Frequency of administration
- Date of dispensing
- Storage requirements (if important)
- Expiry date

The school will not accept items of medication in unlabelled containers.

Provide the school with a letter from the prescribing Doctor if the pupil's need for medication has ceased or changed. (The school will not make changes to dosages on parental instructions).

Renew the medication when supplies are running low

1.

Ensure that the medication supplied is within its expiry date.

Confirm in writing if they wish their child to carry their medication with them in school. *(by completing AM3 form—available on request from Main Office)*

Paracetamol

School will administer paracetamol to students suffering from minor ailments such as headaches and toothache. Paracetamol will not be given before 12 noon to avoid any risk of exceeding the maximum dose recommended. A note will be sent home to inform parents of the time, reason and person who administered the paracetamol. Where a pupil's request for painkillers becomes regular, the parent will be contacted, a further guidance from the GP requested.

2.

The Vice Principal will:

Ensure medication is kept in a secure place out of the reach of pupil. Unless otherwise indicated, all medication to be administered in school will be kept in a locked cabinet.

Ensure records are kept on the individual pupils administrated medication and have these records available for parents upon request.

Inform parent/carer if a children refuses to take medicines (staff will not force them to do so) as a matter of urgency on the same day. If a refusal to take medicines results in an emergency the school's emergency procedure will be followed.

Ensure date expired medicines or those no longer required for treatment are returned immediately to the parent/carer for transfer to a community pharmacist for safe disposal.

3.

For

Classroom Rules:

- Pupils must cooperate fully with the teacher.
- Pupils are expected to behave respectfully towards teachers, parents, other pupils and visitors to the school.
- Pupils are expected to work to the best of their ability and to present written exercises neatly.
- Pupils must respect school property and the property of others.
- Pupils must not shout out answers in class and they must take turns as directed by the teacher.
- Bad language and rude gestures will not be tolerated.
- Pupils may only leave the classroom when they have the permission of the teacher.
- In the interest of safety, pupils are not allowed to run in the classroom.
- Pupils must use the bins provided for litter and for recycling. They must cooperate in keeping the classroom tidy.
- If the teacher has to leave the room, the pupils must remain seated and be of good behaviour.
- School bags should be stored neatly under pupils' tables.
- Pupils are not allowed to bring mobile phones, iPods, electronic games to school.
- Pupils are not allowed to bring in toys for their own recreational use.
- Pupils must keep the four legs of their chair on the floor and not lean back on their chairs.
- Pupils must adhere to Covid-19 prevention measures when applicable.
- Any form of bullying is not tolerated.

Playground Rules:

- Pupils may only go out to the playground when the teacher on duty is

out there.

- Pupils must cooperate fully with the teacher on duty.
- Pupils must respect school property.
- Pupils must not behave in a manner which may harm themselves or others.
- Bad language or rude gestures will not be tolerated.
- Any form of bullying will not be tolerated.
- Spitting is forbidden.
- In the interest of safety, the climbing of walls and gates is forbidden.
- Pupils must not go down the side or the back of the school unless they have permission.
- Pupils may only enter the school building during break time with permission from the teacher on duty.

Pupils from the senior classroom are responsible for gathering litter from the yard.each pupil with long term medical issues, ensure that a Medication Plan and Protocol is drawn up in conjunction with the appropriate health professionals.

Ensure that Staff who assist in the administration of medication will receive appropriate training/guidance through arrangements made with the School Health Service

NB: Prescribed daily routine medication will be administered and witnessed by class staff will be administered by class staff.

FIRE SAFETY PROCEDURES



- All pupils must respect the fact that the playground is an area for all age groups at break time and they should avoid any play or behaviour that endangers themselves or others.
- Pupils are not allowed outside the school gates during school hours

without permission.

- Pupils must not gather around the step at the door.

Pupils ~~Roles and Responsibilities~~

Governors are responsible for ensuring:

- ~~EA policy and guidance in respect of fire safety is adopted and implemented~~
- ~~a safe working environment for all staff~~
- ~~relevant training is undertaken by staff~~
- ~~policies and procedures are in place for safe evacuation of the premises and fire risk reduction~~
- ~~all staff are fully aware of their roles and responsibilities re fire safety~~
- ~~any guidance/direction issued by EA following an annual fire risk assessment is implemented~~

The Principal (or his/her deputy) is responsible for ensuring:

- ~~the day to day management/safety of the premises in relation to fire safety~~
- ~~staff are trained (when training is available from EA)~~
- ~~all staff follow fire safety policy and guidance~~
- ~~adequate records are maintained and available for inspection~~
- ~~a fire safety drill is held termly (timed and recorded by the building supervisor)~~
- ~~reporting to the governors any areas of concern/actions taken relating to fire safety~~
- ~~guests to school events held are made aware of evacuation procedures~~
- ~~new and substitute staff are aware of policy and procedure in relation to Fire Safety~~
- ~~staff training is arranged~~



~~Teachers are responsible for ensuring that:~~

- ~~areas they use have a fire drill notice. (Appendix 2)~~
- ~~the content of the notice is understood by pupils~~
- ~~they have shared with pupils how to raise a fire alarm~~
- ~~they have taught pupils what to do if they find themselves alone or unsupervised when the fire alarm sounds~~
- ~~a pupil who requires a Personal Evacuation Plan has one drawn up and that this is shared with relevant staff~~
- ~~secondary aged pupils sign out if leaving the building for lunch~~
- ~~displays do not contain plastic or highly flammable materials~~
- ~~Flammable materials (petrol, gas etc.) are locked away in appropriate storage and containers away from other combustible materials e.g. wood or paper~~



~~The Building Supervisor is responsible for ensuring that:~~

- ~~public areas have a fire drill notice. (Appendix 2)~~
- ~~the fire alarm system and emergency lighting is inspected annually by an EA appointed contractor~~
- ~~testing the alarm system, emergency exits and lighting as per EA schedule~~
- ~~any reported/identified faults re the fire alarm, firefighting equipment, fire doors, emergency exits and lighting are reported to maintenance for repair~~
- ~~cleaning staff are aware of their duties re fire safety and don't wedge open doors when in a room, dispose of all combustible waste appropriately and securely store flammable liquids etc. at the end of their shift~~
- ~~waste bins are chained together and stored away from external doors~~
- ~~when setting up for public events fire exits are clear, there is adequate aisle space and that chairs are firmly linked together~~
- ~~liaising with the principal re fire safety concerns~~

It is the responsibility of ALL staff to ensure:

- ~~a safe working environment is maintained~~
- ~~pupil safety in the event of a fire alarm~~
- ~~they quickly raise the alarm if they discover a fire~~

- they are fully aware of the location of all fire exits
- rooms used by staff (including staffroom, ICT suites and photocopying room) are kept free of combustible materials (particularly waste paper)
- they fully understand the evacuation procedure and fire safety policies and how these translate into daily practice
- they know the code for the gate key boxes in primary playground
- all exits (and the path to them) from to/their rooms are free from obstructions
- electrical equipment is turned off and if appropriate unplugged, computers are powered down at the end of the school day and electrical items are not left to charge over night
- all faults/concerns (relating to fire safety) are reported promptly to the building supervisor and or principal
- fire doors are kept closed and not wedged or hooked open
- they sign in and out at the start and end of the working day

Leaving the building:

- if leaving the building during the working day (other than with a class or at lunchtime) staff should sign out
- if during lunchtime or with a class the signing out sheet must be completed
- pupils leaving school early with parents must be signed out

Fire Alarm and Evacuation Procedures

In the event of fire, the safety of life overrides all other considerations, such as saving property and extinguishing the fire. If a fire is discovered, the alarm should be raised immediately by the operation of a "break glass" manual call point (Figure 1). This should be the first action taken on the discovery of any fire, however small. All employees are empowered to take this action if they believe there is a fire. The board will always support employees who operate the fire alarm system in good faith, regardless of whether or not it is ultimately determined that a fire existed.

No member of staff is required to attempt to extinguish a fire, but this may be done if there is a clear means of escape and the employee is comfortable with using the extinguisher.

 **Immediate** evacuation of the building must take place as soon as the evacuation signal is given – a continuous loud bell. **All occupants** must report to the designated assembly point at each location within the school

All workers have a duty to conduct their operations in such a way as to minimise the risk of fire, keeping combustible materials separate from sources of ignition, and avoiding unnecessary accumulation of combustible materials.

Fire detection equipment

Manually operated fire alarm points are located at the exit doors of the building. Breaking the glass in the fire alarm point will immediately activate the fire alarm system. It is the responsibility of each employee to activate the alarm on discovering a fire, and to be conversant with the location of the fire alarm points.

Figure 1: Fire alarm point



Fire fighting equipment

Fire extinguishers are located at strategic points throughout the workplace. A Fire Point sign denotes these (Figure 2 refers). All personnel should familiarise themselves with the positions of the fire extinguishers. Four different types of extinguisher are provided. These are:

Type	Colour	Use for	Not to be used on
Water	Red	Paper, wood	Electrical equipment, or burning oil
Foam	Red with Cream Band	Oils, fats, paints	Electrical or metal

Carbon dioxide Co2	Red with Black Band	Electrical fires	
Powder	Red with Blue Band	Flammable liquids and gases	Solvent, material, wood

A fire equipment supplier checks all fire extinguishers annually.

Employees are only expected to tackle a fire themselves if they feel suitably capable and a means of escape is always available to them and they are fully conversant and comfortable with extinguisher usage. The alarm should always be activated first.

Figure 2: Fire point



Fire doors

Fire doors are designed to slow the spread of fire and smoke, are installed at strategic points throughout the building. Fire doors must never be blocked, jammed or tied open.

Figure 3: Fire door sign



Fire exits

Emergency exit doors are located on the ground floor of buildings. Pressing downward on the quick release mechanism fitted on each door will open these doors (see Figure 4). **Exit doors and corridors must never be locked, blocked or used as storage space.**

Figure 4: Emergency exit doors



Smoking

Smoking is prohibited in all areas of the school grounds.

Practice fire drills

Practice fire drills will be conducted at regular intervals to ensure employee familiarity with emergency evacuation procedures. All members of staff are encouraged to report any shortfalls they may observe in the evacuation arrangement in the course of practice fire drills.

Fire Wardens

In an emergency situation fire marshals will assume control. Their role is to clear the buildings as quickly and safely as possible. Their instructions to evacuate the building in both trial and real emergencies

must be followed at all times. The names of fire wardens are displayed in classrooms and are known to all members of staff.

Evacuation control officer – the school principal

The evacuation control officer co-ordinates the evacuation of the building. The fire wardens report to them at the meeting point.

The named deputy is the vice principal who is located on site for the majority of the working day.

Fire evacuation procedure

1. Activate the nearest alarm on discovery of any fire, however small, immediately by breaking the “push glass to break” alarm point. These are located at the exits of the building.
2. Inform the principal / office or fire warden of the fire location and type.
3. After raising the alarm, and only if your means of escape is clear & you feel competent, attack the fire using a suitable extinguisher.
4. Evacuate the building by the nearest safe route as soon as the evacuation signal is given. Do not wait to conclude meetings or telephone calls, or to collect belongings. Walk quickly and calmly closing all doors behind you.
5. Staff must escort or direct pupils out of the building.
6. Stand well clear of the exits when you leave the building.
7. Go to the designated assembly point.
8. **Under no circumstances should you leave the site assembly point during either a trial or real fire evacuation.**
9. Report to your fire warden and wait further instructions.
10. Do not re-enter the building until informed it is safe to do so.
11. Employees/pupils should be told or shown how to activate the alarm
13. The reason for closing doors should be explained during induction training
12. The Principal will complete an induction with all new staff members

Please note:

- Entering a smoke filled building to search for missing persons should not be attempted. The decision to search a building for a missing person should only be taken by a fire warden
- Searching for a missing child/person should never be done alone. Staff should not attempt to tackle a fire. The priority is to preserve life and evacuate the building as quickly as possible

Responsibilities the event of a Fire Alarm

Principal or Vice principal

In the event of fire or practice

- Check office area/Art suite, reception and corridor to collect hall, dining room & kitchen and ensure all fire doors are closed and area safely evacuated
- Advise staff when to re-enter the school

In the event of a fire

- Liaise with the fire brigade on arrival to scene
- Liaise with EA, transport, Thornfield school, Chairperson of Governors

Office staff:

- ~~Put sign at front door alerting visitors not to enter~~

~~1. Take~~

~~Take to the assembly point:~~

- ~~1. Class lists~~
- ~~2. Staff signing in sheet~~
- ~~3. Visitors book~~
- ~~4. Children collected sheet~~
- ~~5. Staff pupil signing in/out sheet~~
- ~~6. Asbestos File~~
- ~~7. Pupil contact files~~

Building Supervisor

~~In the event of fire practice~~

- ~~agree timing with principal~~
- ~~Trigger alarm~~
- ~~Time the evacuation of the building~~
- ~~Advise principal of timing and record practice in fire safety logbook noting any issues~~

~~In the event of an alarm being triggered (unplanned)~~

- ~~Check fire alarm panel to establish issue~~
- ~~Await communication from fire wardens via walkie talkie regarding their area.~~
- ~~Reset alarm panels after drill or false alarm~~

~~The senior clerical officer will take on this role in the absence of the building supervisor~~

Class Staff

- ~~Line up the children in the classroom~~
- ~~take the attendance register with them~~
- ~~move in single file to the tarmac area beside the soft play building~~
- ~~follow the Personal Evacuation Plan for those students who have them~~
- ~~check roll from attendance register~~
- ~~anyone missing to be reported to the principal~~
- ~~do not leave the assembly point for any reason until permission has been given by the principal~~

Fire Wardens

~~Zone 1: Staff block & 3 canteen and collect hall—Miss Laura Matchett (backed up by Mrs Caroline McCarthy)~~

~~Zone 2: Secondary corridor—Mrs Lorraine McCready (backed up by Mrs Lynda O'Connor)~~

~~Zone 4: Primary corridor—Mrs Cara McGoev (backed up by Nichola Shannon)~~

~~Zone 5: Sports hall & Mobile unit—Mr James Edge (backed up by Mr Willie~~

~~Shirlow)~~

~~Zone 6: Early years corridor & Woodwork area—Mr Aston (backed up by Louise McClurkin)~~

Fire Wardens role

Fire wardens should be familiar with their allocated area and the alternative escape routes. They are authorised to assume control and;

1. ~~Lift fire wardens vest, mobile phone and walkie talkie. Channel 8.~~
2. ~~Direct personnel out of their allocated area.~~
3. ~~Check that all areas, including toilets, have been vacated.~~
4. ~~Report to the control officer via walkie talkie to confirm that their area has been cleared, or state the sections that they were unable to check.~~
5. ~~Proceed to the assembly point, closing doors en-route, and liaising with colleagues to ensure that the building is vacated.~~
6. ~~If necessary call the emergency services as soon as you have reached the assembly point.~~
7. ~~Report to control officer at the assembly point.~~

~~Fire wardens are not to remain or argue with persons refusing to leave.~~ They should note the person's name and location and report the matter to the control officer.

Fire Wardens should:

- ❖ ~~Refuse all entry to the building until the emergency is over;~~
- ❖ ~~Check all remote rooms/areas for lone workers;~~
- ❖ ~~Assist in directing the Fire Service to the location of the fire;~~



- ~~Other~~ should not harm or kill any little creatures that live in the school yard and should not interfere with the plants.

Emergency Evacuations

~~There may be any number of reasons necessitating the evacuation of part or the whole of the school building. The nature of the reason may have implications on how the normal evacuation can be adhered to and it may therefore require a degree of flexibility and for decisions to be taken instantly. It is not possible to give a comprehensive analysis of every eventuality but the aim of this part of our policy is to outline general points to be followed as closely as the situation will allow, minimising confusion, misunderstanding and danger. Examples of other situation which might warrant other emergency evacuation include: bomb alert, gas or water leak, a violent or aggressive intruder or visitor, a violent or aggressive pupil.~~

In case of other emergency

~~In the case of an emergency other than a fire, the bell will be rung in seven short rings followed by another seven sort rings and the following procedure operates in the same way an evacuation for fire:~~

- ~~fire wardens lift walkie talkies and mobile phones~~
- ~~children are lined up in the room~~
- ~~teacher to take the attendance register with them~~
- ~~move in single file to the tarmac area beside the soft play building (unless you have received other instructions regarding a different meeting point)~~

- check roll from attendance register
- anyone missing to be reported to the principal
- no person must leave the assembly point for any reason until permission has been given by the principal or vice principal

The PSNI will be called if it is felt that there is any danger to a member of the school community.

~~The principal or vice principal will immediately instigate an evacuation of the building using the emergency evacuate alarm signal—the school bell will be rung in seven short rings, followed by seven more short rings.~~

~~If the usual meeting area is deemed an unsafe place the principal will inform staff of where they are to take the children through walkie talkie communication with fire wardens.~~

~~Obviously if there is knowledge of an area of the school that is unsafe then children will be directed away from this area. A decision to evacuate the pupils outside or to move the pupils further away from the school will be taken by the principal, vice principal or senior teacher depending on the perceived risk prior to the arrival of the~~

~~PSNI.~~

~~The decision will depend on the nature of the situation. It may be possible to isolate a perpetrator in a safe way in a location away from others. It may be necessary for the pupils to be evacuated off site, or to remain in their rooms until the situation has been made safe. These decisions will be taken locally by a senior member of staff based on their view of what would be best for those on site.~~

~~The PSNI will take charge of the situation as soon as they arrive on scene.~~

~~Once the incident has been resolved either by the staff or by the PSNI, a written report of the incident will be completed and a review as to how the matter was addressed will be carried out.~~

~~If it is necessary to move further away from the school then this will be done in a safe and orderly manner. Teachers should endeavour to keep the children calm and safe in their class groups. Everyone will initially make their way towards the either Loughshore park or Jordanstown school depending on the place and nature of danger.~~

~~If parents arrive to collect their children during this movement then it is essential that teachers only release their child to a responsible adult, and makes a note of who has gone and who has taken the child. This will ensure that no child is unaccounted for in any confusion that may occur.~~

~~The school will either be declared safe and pupils will return to their normal activities, or it will become obvious that there will be a long delay in returning to normal business and the principal will make the decision to dismiss the pupils for the day. No one will be permitted to re-enter the building until the PSNI have given permission for this to happen.~~

~~The school will have an up-to-date emergency contact list which will be brought with the secretary, principal and vice principal. The principal will endeavour to gain permission to use Thornfield school or Jordanstown school as a safe place to gather. The vice principal will contact the other offices on site if necessary.~~

TRAINING

~~All staff will receive a copy of the school Health and Safety Policy~~

~~The Principal and Vice Principal will identify related training needs and be responsible for training of staff to ensure the site remains compliant. Specific training will be related to job function and nominated responsibilities.~~

Review

~~A copy of this policy will be issued to all employees and is available under Microsoft Staff Whole School Team. Channel School Policies. It will be reviewed, added to or modified as necessary and may be~~

supplemented in appropriate cases by further statements relating to the work of particular groups of children, staff or visitor.

Appendix 1

Health and safety induction for all new staff

Health and safety forms a significant component part of any induction training system. Fire safety and emergency evacuation procedures for new staff in the work place or new students in schools, should include the following:—

- Conducted tour of building indicating items worthy of note, e.g. emergency exits, break glass points, alternative routes, assembly point(s) etc.
- Fire warning system. The system should be explained with a demonstration of the audible warning. The use of continuous rings and intermittent rings should be explained if applicable.
- All means of escape should be indicated to building users. They should be signed appropriately to aid identification.
- Action on discovering a fire should be explained to staff/pupils and their attention should be drawn to the 'FIRE ACTION' placards on display.
- Location of fire fighting equipment will be pointed out to those taking part in the induction course. This will be done during the conducted tour. Training in its use will be made available at a later stage.
- Fire drill systems should be explained e.g. frequency of drills, target evacuation times, action at assembly points etc.
- The policy in relation to smoking at work will be explained and a copy of the policy will be made available to staff.
- Out of bounds, or restricted areas will be indicated to those who use the building. An explanation of why there is restriction will be provided.
- A brief outline of good house keeping practices that aid emergency evacuation will be given, e.g. keeping corridors and emergency exits free from obstructions etc.
- The reasons why fire stop doors should be kept closed during normal occupation and while evacuating the building will be explained.
- All breakdowns or faults in the emergency evacuation system or procedures should be reported immediately to management for investigation and remedy.

The above listed are key items to be covered in relation to the evacuation procedures. They are interrelated and could be adequately covered in a 45 minute training session (including 15 minutes conducted tour).

Fire Alarm and Evacuation Procedures

Discovery of a fire

Raise the alarm by breaking the nearest breakglass

Alarm Signal: Continuous ringing of the electric bell

Assembly Point: Tarmacked area beside soft play

Action

- Quickly and calmly direct children (in walk and single file) to the nearest fire exit
- Do not collect bags, coats, etc. and make sure that the door is closed when you leave
- Quickly move to the assembly point
- Ensure that all pupils in your care are accounted for
- Immediately report any missing child or staff member to a fire warden

- ~~Do not re-enter the building until advised to do so by the principal~~

~~**Treat all alarms as if there is a fire and evacuate the building.**~~